



Pension Credit

Pension Credit is a means-tested benefit for older people who have a relatively low income and have reached the qualifying State Pension Age. Pension Credit is means-tested, so how much you get will depend on your personal circumstances and the level of your savings and other income.

Pension Credit is administered by the Pensions Service and is not taxed.

Changes to Pension Credit from 15/05/19

If you are a couple and looking to claim Pension Credit then either:

- you and your partner need to have reached Pension Credit qualifying age
- one of you is Pension Credit qualifying age and is claiming Housing Benefit (for you as a couple)

Pension Credit is made of two elements

1. Guaranteed Credit - this is for people who have reached the qualifying age and is designed to top up your income to a minimum level. It ensures that you receive an income of at least £227.10 a week if you are single or £346.60 a week if you have a partner.
2. Savings Credit - is designed to reward people who have saved some money for their retirement. It provides an extra amount based on the level of your other income or savings. It can be up to £17.30 a week if you are single or £19.36 a week if you have a partner. You can only claim the Savings Credit element if you are State Pension Age or over at April 2016.

It is possible to qualify for one or both elements

To find out your exact Pension Credit qualifying age, call the Pension Service on 0800 731 0469 or check the state pension age calculator at www.gov.uk/calculate-state-pension

How low does my income have to be to qualify for the Guaranteed Credit?

You will qualify for the Guaranteed Credit if your weekly income is less than:

- £227.10 if you are single
- £346.60 if you have a partner

You may still qualify if your weekly income is more than the amounts above if you or your partner receive Attendance Allowance, Disability Living Allowance (DLA), Personal Independence Payment (PIP) or you care for someone who receives a disability benefit. You may also qualify if you have extra housing costs, such as mortgage interest payments or service charges.

How much other income do I have to receive to qualify for the Savings Credit?

You will qualify for the Savings Credit if you have pensions or other income (including income from savings) above the "Savings Credit threshold" which is:

- £198.27 a week if you are single
- £314.34 if you are a couple

If you or your partner have recently been awarded a disability benefit, it is worth checking whether you might be entitled to Pension Credit (or whether your Pension Credit is correct in light of your new circumstances). The calculation for Pension Credit, especially the Savings Credit, can be

complicated. Call us on 0300 500 8080 to check if you are entitled.

Additional amounts you may be able to receive

The Pension Service may include additional amounts in your Pension Credit award in the following circumstances:

Severe Disability Premium

You are entitled to an extra amount for severe disability if:

- You get Attendance Allowance, PIP (any rate of the daily living component) or the middle or higher rate of the DLA care component
- And no one gets Carer's Allowance for looking after you
- And you live alone or can be treated as living alone.

The Pensions Service will treat you as living alone if the person you live with is registered blind, or they get Attendance Allowance, PIP (any rate of the daily living component) or the middle or higher rate of the DLA care component.

If you are claiming as a couple you cannot get the extra amount for severe disability unless you both fulfil the conditions above.

The severe disability premium is:

- £82.90 a week for a single person or for a couple when only one person qualifies
- £165.80 a week for a couple when both qualify

Carer Premium

You may be entitled to an extra £46.40 a week if you or your partner qualify for Carer's Allowance. You and your partner can each qualify for a carer premium.

You have to apply for Carer's Allowance to get this additional amount, but it doesn't matter whether you are actually paid Carer's Allowance or not.

For example, you may not receive any Carer's Allowance if you are already receiving your State Retirement Pension, but you can still get the extra amount for carers included in your Pension Credit.

This will depend on the "appropriate amount" the Pensions Service think you should receive. Please see below for how this is calculated, or for further information about Carers Allowance, please see our Carers Allowance factsheet.

How will the Pension Service calculate my Pension Credit?

The Pension Service will calculate:

- Guaranteed Credit element by working out an "appropriate amount" for your circumstances and comparing it with your income. Your appropriate amount is the single or couple rate of Guarantee Credit, plus any extra amounts or housing costs you are entitled to. If your income is less than your total appropriate amount you will receive some Guarantee Credit
- Savings Credit element by comparing your income with the "Savings Credit threshold" of £198.27 for a single person or £314.34 for a couple. The maximum amount of Savings Credit any single person could receive is £17.30 or £19.36 for a couple.

How your income and savings affect your Pension Credit

The Pension Service takes into account income you earn when working out how much Pension Credit you should receive. This includes your State Retirement Pension, any occupational pension or personal pension you or your partner may receive, and most other benefits. If you have a partner your joint income and capital are added together.

The Pension Service ignores Attendance Allowance, DLA and PIP as income, as well as Housing Benefit. If you receive income from a trust fund, the Pension Service will normally take this into account, unless the trust fund

was set up with money you received for a personal injury.

When looking at your capital and savings, the Pension Service ignores:

- the first £10,000 of your savings and capital. This includes ISAs, shares or unit trusts, premium bonds, and income or capital bonds. There is no upper savings limit that stops you making a claim for Pension Credit
- the property that you live in (but the value of any other property and land you own is usually counted)
- certain amounts of capital such as lump-sum payments for personal injury.
- arrears of certain state benefits (for up to a year)

If your capital is above £10,000 the Pension Service will assume that it generates an amount of weekly income: £1 a week for every £500 (or part of £500) over £10,000. You do not need to tell the Pension Service about any interest or dividends you receive from savings.

How to claim Pension Credit

You can call the Pension Credit claim line on 0800 99 1234 from 8am to 6pm Monday to Friday (if you have speech or hearing difficulties, the text phone number is 0800 169 0133). Pension Service staff can help you make an application over the phone. You can also download a Pension Credit claim form from www.gov.uk/pension-credit

To make a claim for Pension Credit you will need to provide the following information about yourself (and your partner if you have one):

- your National Insurance number
- information about your pensions and other income
- details of your capital, savings and investments.

Help with your rent and Council Tax

You can also apply for help with your rent and Council Tax at the same time as applying for Pension Credit.

If you claim Pension Credit over the phone, the Pension Service can forward your information to your local council, so that they can assess your entitlement to Housing Benefit and/or Council Tax Support.

Pension Credit, Housing Benefit and Council Tax Support can be backdated for up to three months from the date of your claim, provided that you would have qualified for the benefit during that period.

If you are entitled to the Guarantee Credit element of Pension Credit you will also qualify for Housing Benefit and Council Tax Support regardless of the level of your savings. If you receive Savings Credit only, you will have to make a separate application for these two benefits.

Help with health costs

If you get the Guarantee Credit element of Pension Credit, you and your partner will qualify for help with health costs. This includes help with NHS dental costs, vouchers towards the cost of glasses and free NHS sight tests. If you get the savings credit only you may still be able to get help with NHS costs through the NHS Health Benefits Low Income Scheme. Contact the Health Cost advice line on 0300 330 1343 to obtain a claim form.

Free TV Licence

As of 1st August 2020, there will be a new TV Licence scheme. Under the new scheme, anyone aged 75 or over who receives Pension Credit will still be eligible for a Free TV Licence.

To discuss your entitlement or apply for a free TV Licence call 0300 790 6117.

If you need further advice on claiming Pension Credit, you can contact Nottinghamshire County Council for more information using the details provided below.

Contact information:

Phone: 0300 500 80 80

Monday - Friday, opening times may vary.

Calls are charged at local rate.

Website: www.nottinghamshire.gov.uk

Phone 0300 500 80 80 if you need the information in a different language or format.

The Council is committed to protecting your privacy and ensuring all personal information is kept confidential and safe. For more details see our general and service specific privacy notices

at: <https://www.nottinghamshire.gov.uk/global-content/privacy>